

HOW TO BUILD THE NEIGHBORHOOD CATS WINTER SHELTER

Materials

- hard Styrofoam sheet, 2 ft. wide, 8 ft. long, 2 in. thick
- one tube that fits a caulk gun of paintable or clear silicone sealant (such as GE Window & Door Sealant) *or* two smaller hand-squeezable tubes of paintable or clear silicone sealant. Paintable sealant is preferred.
- vinyl remnant (18" x 20") *or* three 1 ft. square pieces of thin linoleum tile with adhesive backing
- Latex deck paint (approx. 1 quart)

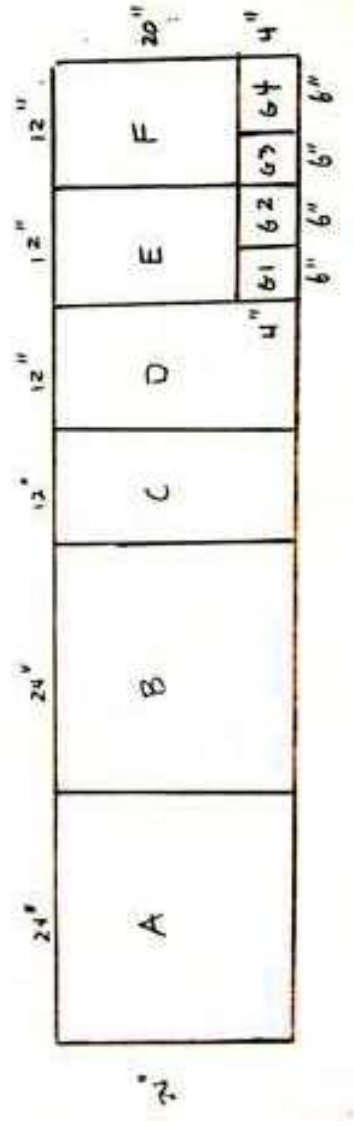
Tools

- table saw
- utility knife (with extendable blade) or jigsaw
- caulk gun
- painting equipment: brush/roller, paint tray, ground cloth
- felt tip marker
- yardstick
- scissors (if you're using the thin linoleum tiles)

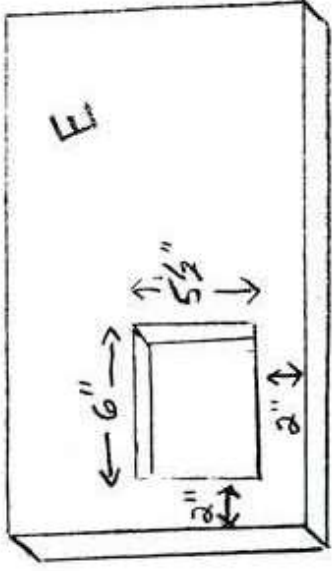
Instructions

1. Using a table saw, cut the Styrofoam sheet into the following pieces:

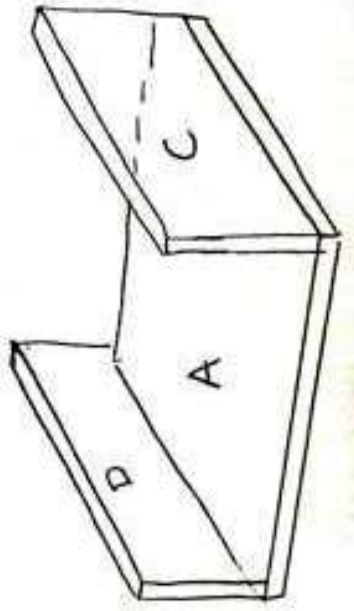
- two of 24" x 24" (pieces A & B)
- two of 12" x 24" (pieces C & D)
- two of 12" x 20" (pieces E & F)
- four of 4" x 6" (pieces G1, G2, G3 & G4)



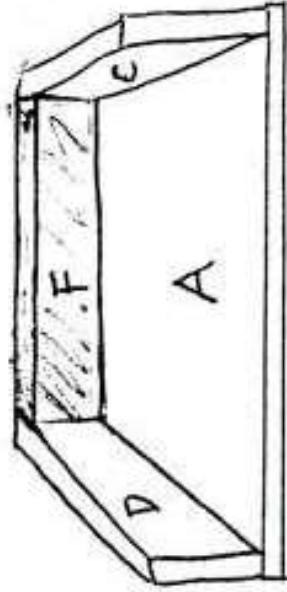
2. Cut out the front door of the shelter from piece E (12" x 20"). Using the yardstick and felt pen, draw a rectangle measuring 5 1/2" high and 6" wide, located 2" from the left vertical edge of piece E and 2" from the horizontal bottom edge. Use the utility knife (or preferably a jig saw) to cut out the rectangle.



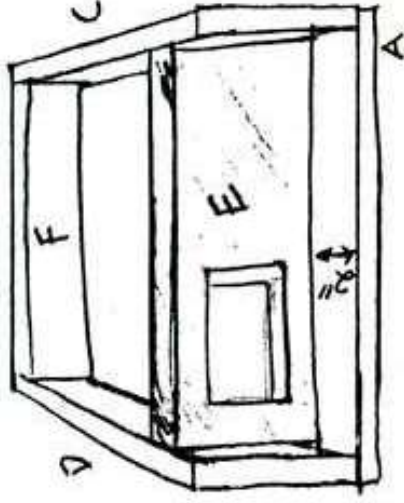
3. Line up the long sides of the shelter on the shelter floor by placing pieces C & D (the two 12" x 24" pieces) on the right and left outer edges of piece A (24" x 24").



4. Place piece F (12" x 20") onto the back edge of piece A.

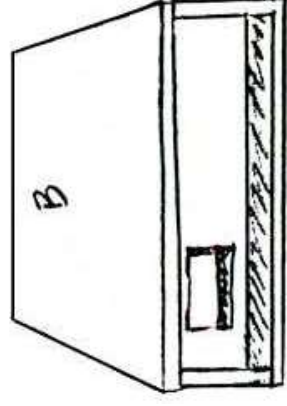


5. Place piece E **two inches back** from the front edge of piece A, making sure the door is in the correct position:

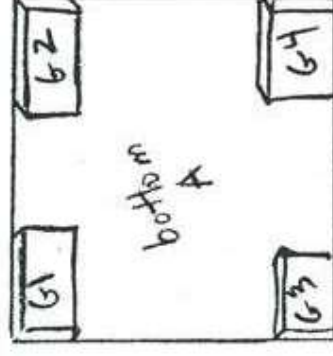


6. Once all four sides are lined up, apply the silicone sealant to the bottom of pieces C, D, E & F, one at a time, and put each piece back in place, gluing them to the floor. Let the sealant dry for a few minutes.
7. Take the 18" x 20" piece of vinyl remnant and attach it to the floor of the shelter with a small amount of the silicone sealant *or* use the three linoleum tiles with adhesive backing.

If you use the tiles, you'll need to cut up two of them to create a total surface measuring 18" x 20". Put one of the tiles aside and from the 2nd tile, cut out a piece measuring 8" x 12"; from the 3rd tile, cut out two pieces – one 6" x 12" and the other 6" x 8". Use the yardstick and felt pen to trace the correct dimensions onto the full tiles and then use the scissors to cut out the correct size pieces. Next, arrange the full tile and the three cut-out pieces so they cover the entire floor and one at a time remove their wax paper backings and apply.



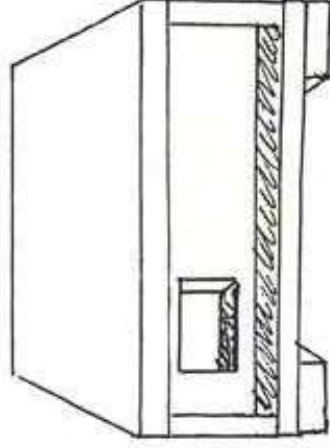
8. Next, attach the roof. Using the sealant, glue piece B onto the top of pieces C, D, E & F. Let it dry for a few minutes.
9. Then attach the legs. Apply silicone sealant to the top sides and press pieces G1, G2, G3 & G4 onto the corners of the bottom of piece A.



10. Seal all seams and cracks of the shelter with the silicone sealant. This is very important! It keeps drafts out. Seal where the roof touches the side walls, where each side wall meets another side wall and where the walls meet the floor. If necessary, purchase and apply an extra tube of silicone sealant.
11. After the silicone glue has completely dried (usually 24 hours), paint the shelter with one or two coats of latex deck paint, matching the color to the surroundings where the shelter will be placed. (NOTE: the paint will not adhere to areas covered with the sealant unless you're using a paintable silicone. If you're using a non-paintable, clear sealant, you can choose to paint all the outer surfaces of the shelter BEFORE gluing them together to avoid leaving unpainted areas.)
12. [**Optional**]: You may eventually want to add a flap to the front door that the cats can easily pull open, such as a piece of a vinyl mat. You can glue or duct tape it on above the front door, or drill holes and use plastic nuts and bolts like the kind used to attach toilet seats. It's recommended you wait until the cats are familiar with going in and out of the shelter before adding a flap.

TIPS:

- The shelters are very light, so weigh them down with a large rock, board, a few bricks, etc. The roof is strong enough to hold a reasonable amount of weight.
- To break the wind and protect from rain, place two shelters with their front doors facing each other and then place a board on top of both, spanning the two roofs.
- Straw is the best insulation for the interior. Shredded newspaper will also work. Don't use hay which is moist and can become moldy. Don't put towels or blankets on the floor – they will draw out body heat and make the cats colder.
- **NEVER PUT WATER INSIDE!!** Small bowls of dry food are ok.
- Draw the cats inside the shelter by scattering tasty treats or catnip near and inside.



COMPLETED SHELTER